

allowance because your kids should be doing their designated household chores for free. Instead, brainstorm some tasks that are separate and distinct from their regular contributions to the household, perhaps washing the car, taking out a pet on walks or doing some simple gardening or spring cleaning. Devise ways for her to earn that money dollar by dollar (or, if you're a real taskmaster, quarter by quarter). Also, your suggestions for tasks are great, but take the opportunity to open a dialogue with your child about skills she has to offer. This is a great way to get your kid to start thinking about her own abilities and monetizing them. After all, these are baby steps designed to stimulate thinking about future jobs and careers.

Oh, and one more thing: you can ditch the Money Bin. She's outgrown it.

Age 10

The Bank Card

At 10, your child is moving into a new stage; you don't have to hold her hand. She knows where money comes from, and hopefully by now she has a genuine appreciation for the fact that money is something you earn, not that you are given. The lessons you impart over the next four years can be a little more complex.

Unless she launched her own start-up in fifth grade, your daughter's bank account probably hasn't seen a lot of action. That's okay. The goal is to train her how to monitor her money. If she has shown herself to be financially responsible, she may be ready for a prepaid bank card. I suggest a *prepaid* card because it allows you to maintain control—you can add money in increments as small as \$5. You can also link the card directly to her savings account, so that any money she spends is her own. Most banks these days have an online dashboard; if possible, set your child up with her own password and encourage her to monitor her account balance. This gives her an easy, fun way to keep track of her money.

Remind her to monitor her account closely. The minute she starts using a bank card, the chances of being a victim to fraud multiply